



Civic Meeting Report

County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Monday, September 18th, Session #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xGevaDf5Hss
Publication Date	2025-09-19T04:29:08Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript begins directly with budget deliberations and does not feature a separate statutory public hearing or committee work session prior to the call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer opened the session following a recess to review updated budget numbers from the budget team and deliberate on county finances and departmental funding requests.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Identified by name or role during discussion: Bill, Nancy, Tanya, Ed (referenced via proposal), Jim, and the presiding officer.
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Led the meeting proceedings and called for council comments.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not applicable in this excerpt (the meeting resumed directly from a recess).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not addressed in this transcript segment.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:00:22 County Budget and Revenue Corrections

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Budget Team / Department Representatives / Presiding Officer.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The board reviewed updated budget numbers, adjusting the county general givebacks. Specifically, a \$20,000 item under the sheriff's budget was removed, bringing the total county general givebacks to \$244,848.
 - Discussion ensued regarding projected year-end balances for 2026, clarifying discrepancies between figures (settling on a projected operating balance projection referencing \$6,141,930 over the base, incorporating prior adjustments and prosecutor givebacks of \$7,038).
 - The council discussed a recent news article regarding \$216,000 owed by the state to Delaware County for back jail/lockup amounts and verified that this expected revenue is accounted for in existing revenue projections.
 - Tanya updated the council regarding approximately \$300,000 in ARP (American Rescue Plan) interest money. She noted she contacted the State Board of Accounts; while promising, the funds cannot be directly transferred into the county general fund. However, they can be expended directly out of the line item where they currently sit (e.g., to pay off voting machines), potentially adjusting final operating balance calculations.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal binding vote was taken on the overall budget during this segment; the council agreed to proceed toward formal adoption at the upcoming Tuesday meeting.

00:10:25 Departmental Salary Increase Proposal (Ed's Office)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tanya (presenting on behalf of Ed).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Tanya presented a salary increase proposal from Ed totaling \$10,963, representing a 2% increase on salaries (\$9,224 gross pay, \$76 FICA, \$1,663 PERF) intended to adjust pay to the internal base.

- Council members expressed strong reservations against approving the increase, citing unsustainable drawdowns on operating reserves and the desire to avoid operating loans and taxpayer-funded interest payments to banks.
 - Members noted that previous adjustments and added benefits (totaling roughly \$660,000 in the budget) have already stretched county finances, and establishing a precedent for further raises without staffing reductions would compound fiscal deficits for future budget cycles.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus against adoption; the request was not advanced, and the council confirmed that an alternate \$1,000 across-the-board raise proposal was also not brought back for consideration.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general public comment or citizen forum period was held during this session; remarks were restricted to council members, department heads, and elected officials.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Council members noted that final budget adjustments can still be addressed prior to formal adoption.
 - Jim (00:16:04) delivered a closing cautionary statement comparing the county's practice of drawing down retirement/operating reserves to cover multi-hundred-thousand-dollar revenue shortfalls to an unsustainable business model, warning that structural deficits projected for 2027 (\$1.5 million to \$2 million short) will worsen if spending patterns remain unchanged.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - **Disposition:** Recessed.
 - **Timestamp:** 00:20:17 <U+2014> The meeting was recessed until Tuesday.
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